

Green Valley Community Hospital

Administrative Governance Office

Governance and Meetings Policy

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Purpose

This policy describes how department meetings are scheduled and run at Green Valley Community Hospital, including how agendas and minutes are prepared. It is intended to keep internal governance simple and easy to follow.

Consistent, well-recorded meetings help departments track decisions over time and make sure that action items are not forgotten between one meeting and the next.

Scope

This policy applies to regular department meetings and other administrative meetings held within Green Valley Community Hospital.

It does not apply to informal day-to-day conversations between staff, or to clinical case discussions, which follow separate clinical procedures outside this administrative policy.

Meeting Schedules

Department meetings are normally held once every month. Each department chooses a regular day and time for its monthly meeting, and this schedule is shared with staff in advance through the internal staff notice board.

In addition to monthly department meetings, the Administrative Governance Office holds a general administrative meeting every three months to review hospital-wide administrative matters.

Meeting Agendas

Meeting agendas should be submitted before the meeting, usually at least two working days in advance, so that the administrative coordinator can prepare and circulate the agenda to attendees.

What an Agenda Should Contain

- A list of topics to be discussed, in order.
- The name of the person presenting each topic.
- An estimated time for each topic, where practical.
- Any documents or reports attendees should review beforehand.

Agenda Submission

Staff members wishing to add a topic to an upcoming meeting agenda should submit it to their department's administrative coordinator before the agenda submission deadline. Topics submitted after the deadline may be added to the following meeting instead.

Attendance

Staff members expected to attend a meeting should confirm their attendance when the agenda is circulated. If a staff member cannot attend, they should inform the meeting organizer in advance so that any topics relevant to them can be addressed appropriately.

For staff members who are unable to attend but still need to be informed of decisions, the meeting organizer can arrange for minutes to be sent to them directly once the meeting has concluded, rather than waiting for the standard general distribution.

Minutes and Meeting Records

Minutes should summarize major decisions and assigned action items. Meeting records are maintained by the administrative coordinator, who is responsible for preparing and distributing minutes after each meeting.

Minutes are usually shared with attendees within three working days after a meeting. Staff members who attended can review the minutes and flag any corrections needed.

Action Items and Follow-Up

Action items identified during a meeting are recorded in the minutes, along with the name of the person responsible and, where possible, a target completion date. Follow-up on action items is usually reviewed at the start of the next meeting.

Meeting Element	Who Prepares It	When
Agenda	Administrative coordinator	Before the meeting, based on submitted topics
Minutes	Administrative coordinator	Within three working days after the meeting
Action item follow-up	Administrative coordinator and responsible staff	Reviewed at the next meeting

Meeting Responsibilities

The meeting organizer, usually a department supervisor or the administrative coordinator, is responsible for scheduling the meeting, confirming the agenda, and ensuring minutes are prepared afterward. Attendees are responsible for reviewing the agenda in advance and completing any assigned action items.

Each department should also designate a backup person who can take minutes if the usual administrative coordinator is unavailable, so that meeting records remain consistent even when key staff are on leave.

Special Meetings

Special meetings can be called outside the regular monthly schedule when an urgent administrative matter needs to be discussed. Special meetings follow the same basic process as regular meetings, though the agenda submission deadline may be shortened depending on the urgency.

Because special meetings are often called on short notice, attendees are asked to make a reasonable effort to attend or to send a representative, since the matters discussed are usually time-sensitive.

Meeting Cancellation

If a scheduled meeting needs to be cancelled, the meeting organizer should inform attendees as early as possible, and, where relevant, propose a new date. Cancelled meetings are noted in the department's meeting records.

Meeting Records Storage

Completed agendas and minutes are stored by the administrative coordinator in the department's meeting records, organized by date. Staff members can request to review past meeting records for their own department by contacting the administrative coordinator.

Keeping organized meeting records also helps new staff members get up to speed quickly, since they can review recent minutes to understand ongoing action items and decisions relevant to their department.

Responsibilities

The Administrative Governance Office is responsible for supporting departments in scheduling meetings and maintaining consistent meeting records across the hospital. Department supervisors are responsible for ensuring their department holds regular meetings and that minutes are properly recorded.

Attendees share responsibility for keeping meetings productive by reviewing the agenda beforehand, arriving on time, and completing any action items assigned to them before the next meeting.

Exceptions

Departments with unusually light administrative workloads may request approval from the Administrative Governance Office to hold meetings less frequently than monthly. This exception is reviewed periodically to confirm it remains appropriate.

During unusually busy periods, a department may also request approval to hold an additional meeting outside the regular monthly schedule, using the same process described for special meetings.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How often are department meetings held?

A: Department meetings are normally held once every month.

Q: Who prepares meeting minutes?

A: Meeting minutes are prepared by the administrative coordinator, who also maintains the department's meeting records.

Q: What information should a meeting agenda contain?

A: An agenda should list the topics to be discussed, who is presenting each topic, an estimated time for each topic, and any documents attendees should review beforehand.

Q: When are minutes shared after a meeting?

A: Minutes are usually shared with attendees within three working days after the meeting.

Q: Can a special meeting be called outside the regular schedule?

A: Yes. Special meetings can be called for urgent administrative matters and follow the same basic process as regular meetings.

Q: What happens to action items after a meeting?

A: Action items are recorded in the minutes along with the responsible person, and follow-up is usually reviewed at the next meeting.

Contact Information

For general questions about this policy, please contact the Administrative Services Desk.

Contact Point	Details
Administrative Services Desk	+1-555-010-2400
General Email	info@greenvalleyhospital.example
Hospital Address	25 Green Valley Road, Riverside District, New Harmony
Desk Hours	Monday to Saturday, 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM